

2026

SCR[®] STUDY GUIDE AND LEARNING OBJECTIVES

2026 **SCR** STUDY GUIDE AND LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Topic Outlines, Readings, and Test Weightings

This SCR Study Guide and Learning Objectives document describes the primary topics covered on the SCR Exam. The SCR Advisory Committee identified these curriculum topics as essential for risk managers and other sustainability professionals navigating the field of sustainability and climate risk. The curriculum is weighted across these topics and re-evaluated annually to ensure the SCR Exam is timely and relevant.

Learning Objectives for each chapter appear as bullet points in this Study Guide. These Learning Objectives are intended to help exam candidates identify major themes associated with each chapter of the SCR Program. The required online readings listed under chapter descriptions are testable for the SCR Exam. Learning Objectives for online readings also appear on the GARP website. Every question on the SCR Exam is directly aligned with one of the designated Learning Objectives.

This document is an important study resource and should be referred to regularly during exam preparation.

SCR Exam Approach

The SCR Exam is practice oriented. The questions are derived from a combination of theory, as set forth in the 2026 SCR Certificate curriculum, and real-world work experience. Candidates are expected to understand sustainability and climate risk concepts and apply these approaches across a range of activities, including risk management, strategy development, operational decision-making, sustainability reporting, and innovation. The 2026 SCR Exam covers knowledge areas necessary for individuals and organizations to succeed in today's rapidly changing sustainability and climate risk landscape.

The Exam is a comprehensive assessment that covers the fundamental guidelines, methodologies, and frameworks

organizations use to anticipate and manage climate risk. It consists of 80 equally-weighted, multiple-choice questions. The majority of Exam questions stand alone, with the exception of one multi-part question case study.

2026 SCR Curriculum

Available through our eLearning platform GARP Learning, or as a purchasable printed book, the 2026 SCR curriculum includes Chapters 1-10. The topics covered by these chapters were selected by the SCR Advisory Committee. It is strongly suggested candidates review the book in depth prior to sitting for the Exam. Each chapter begins with a set of Learning Objectives to guide candidates through their studies. Review questions conclude each chapter.

Access to GARP Learning is provided to all candidates who register for the Exam. The platform gives candidates digital access to the SCR curriculum, including chapter content, learning objectives, and a glossary, as well as study aids like digital flashcards, end-of-chapter questions, and a practice exam. Candidates can track their progress, focus on key areas, and use additional resources like the optional SCR Climate PAL, which is not tested on the Exam.

SCR Errata

GARP will update curriculum clarifications or printing errors in the SCR Errata 2026 document regularly. Candidates can find the SCR Errata document in the candidate portal. If you identify a potential error or curriculum discrepancy, please submit this through the candidate portal, but only after checking the Errata to see if it may already have been addressed.

We welcome all types of submissions including minor editorial, grammar, and typographical errors. However, only substantial errors in content or questions will be posted to the official SCR Errata.

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CHAPTER 1: FOUNDATIONS OF CLIMATE CHANGE: WHAT IS CLIMATE CHANGE?

EXAM WEIGHT | 8-12 questions

Learning Objectives

This chapter describes the science of climate change, including the primary drivers of increased greenhouse gases. Evidence supporting modern warming is described, including rising global temperatures, melting ice, and sea level rise. The chapter also examines the differences between natural and modern climate change, along with the wide-ranging impacts of climate change. Though a wide range of science concepts are covered, a background in high-level mathematics is not needed.

Additionally, the chapter explores the tool kit of policy responses needed to address climate change. Topics include adaptation, mitigation, and geoengineering, with discussions on renewable energy, carbon capture, and natural climate solutions. The chapter concludes with a call for urgent emission reductions to meet Paris Agreement targets and avoid surpassing critical warming thresholds.

The specific Learning Objectives for this chapter are as follows:

- Define climate change and differentiate between weather and climate.
- Identify the evidence used to support modern climate change trends.
- Describe the Earth's climate history, and different methods for measuring non-anthropogenic climate change.
- Understand how the Earth's energy balance and the greenhouse effect affect the climate.
- Know the primary greenhouse gases and aerosols, their sources, and relative contributions to climate change.
- Explain non-human and human mechanisms that contribute to climate change.
- Understand the distribution, frequency, and intensity of climate driven environmental impacts.
- Understand the distribution, frequency, and intensity of climate driven socioeconomic impacts.
- Explain the different approaches and key considerations of climate change adaptation, including maladaptation.
- Identify the opportunities, strategies, technologies, and associated challenges of mitigating climate change.
- Understand the opportunities and drawbacks of implementing geoengineering techniques to combat climate change.
- Explain carbon budgets, national commitments, and emissions scenarios to limit temperature increases.

CHAPTER 2: SUSTAINABILITY

EXAM WEIGHT | 8-12 questions

Learning Objectives

This chapter discusses the broad topic of “sustainability” and explores how it is implemented across public policy, corporate actions, and financial institutions. A broad perspective of sustainability in a policy, corporate, and investment context is necessary before examining climate risk analysis (Chapters 3 and 6) and policy frameworks (Chapter 4) in greater detail. This chapter also discusses international goals on sustainability, most notably the UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

The chapter takes a broad approach, touching on economic development, issues of social justice and equity (e.g., human rights), and environmental protection (e.g., biodiversity), laying the groundwork for more-detailed discussions in later chapters.

The specific Learning Objectives for this chapter are as follows:

- Define the three different aspects of sustainability.
- Explain how different entities use ESG, corporate responsibility, and sustainable development criteria to implement and report sustainability and climate practices.
- Explain the relationship and intersection between sustainability, ESG, and/or climate change.
- Discuss strategies for implementing and aligning with the SDGs and how SDG alignment can be material to companies.
- Define ecosystem services, subcomponents, and natural capital.
- Describe the evolution of sustainability in governments, corporations, and financial institutions.
- Describe how organizations “greenwash” sustainability claims and the actions taken to address these practices.
- Describe the life-cycle assessment process and how organizations use this tool to advance sustainability.
- Understand sustainability reporting frameworks and initiatives, their objectives, and to whom they are targeted.

Required Online Readings:

“UNEPFI Principles For Responsible Banking,” United Nations Environment Programme Finance Initiative. (pages 3-38).

The specific Learning Objectives for this online reading are as follows:

- Explain the requirements and suggested measures to take for each principle of responsible banking.
- Understand and describe how banks have implemented the responsible banking principles, along with the benefits of implementing these principles.

“UNPRI Principles For Responsible Investment,” Principles for Responsible Investment, 2021.

The specific Learning Objective for this online reading is as follows:

- Identify the six principles of responsible investment and potential ways to achieve them.

All required online readings can be accessed at <https://www.garp.org/scr/readings/required>.

CHAPTER 3:

CLIMATE CHANGE RISK

EXAM WEIGHT | 8-12 questions

Learning Objectives

This chapter introduces the concept of climate risk, including physical risk and transition risk. It describes the factors that determine the severity of climate risk, and how these risks can lead to financial loss. The text also emphasizes that climate risk is not just a future concern; physical climate risks are already impacting a wide range of sectors.

The chapter further explores how transition risk can rapidly devalue assets or force costly strategic pivots. Sector-specific case studies illustrate how both physical and transition risks are transmitted into the broader economy. Ultimately, the chapter emphasizes the urgency for firms and financial institutions to integrate climate risk into decision-making to avoid losses and seize emerging opportunities.

The specific Learning Objectives for this chapter are as follows:

- Describe how physical and transition climate risks can translate to financial risk.
- Understand how hazards/drivers, exposure, and vulnerability interact to create physical and transition risks.
- Define stranded assets and discuss how different sectors may experience stranded asset risk.
- Differentiate acute and chronic hazards.
- Discuss uncertainty, variability, and accuracy in hazard model predictions.
- Identify data challenges modeling direct physical risk.
- Identify examples of indirect physical risks.
- Discuss how physical and transition risks can present opportunities for companies and sectors.
- Describe the drivers of transition risk (e.g., technology, market) and provide examples.
- Discuss human capital as a stranded asset and the challenges associated with a just transition.

Required Online Reading:

“Risk Management Fundamentals,” Global Association of Risk Professionals (GARP), December 2022.

The specific Learning Objectives for this online reading are as follows:

- Define the major categories of financial risk faced by organizations.
- Understand how risk managers identify, measure, and manage credit risk, market risk, liquidity risk, and operational risk.

All required online readings can be accessed at <https://www.garp.org/scr/readings/required>.

CHAPTER 4:

SUSTAINABILITY AND CLIMATE POLICY, CULTURE, AND GOVERNANCE

EXAM WEIGHT | 8-12 questions

Learning Objectives

This chapter explores the evolution of sustainability and climate policy, emphasizing international agreements, national regulations, and private-sector initiatives. It traces the development from early frameworks like the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) and Kyoto Protocol, to the more inclusive Paris Agreement. The text also examines the rise of subnational and non-state actors in driving climate ambition and innovation. Corporate emissions accounting is introduced, along with the complexities of double counting and the growing importance of standardized reporting frameworks like the GHG Protocol.

The chapter also delves into how climate risk is being integrated into financial policy and supervision. Additionally, it introduces nature-related risks, emphasizing the interconnectedness of climate and ecological systems. The chapter concludes by acknowledging the societal and political dynamics shaping climate action, noting both the momentum from bottom-up pressures and the headwinds from geopolitical and economic disruptions.

The specific Learning Objectives for this chapter are as follows:

- Discuss the evolution of international climate policy.
- Understand the relative scale of emissions by country and region.
- Summarize the history, outcomes, and obligations of major international climate agreements.
- Explain the structure, benefits, and drawbacks of carbon pricing policies.
- Describe sector-specific climate policies, including the policies that govern the transportation and power generation sectors.
- Differentiate Scope 1, 2, and 3 emissions.
- Recognize the challenges associated with accounting for Scope 3 emissions.
- Differentiate the types of private-sector sustainability and climate investment policies, and how public policy has been used to promote green finance.
- Describe the function, purpose, and challenges of green taxonomies.
- Discuss how central banks incorporate climate change into supervision practices.
- Describe the trends in private-sector climate frameworks and the characteristics of important climate groupings.
- Explain nature-related risks, including human impacts on biodiversity and ecosystem services.

Required Online Readings:

“A call for action: Climate change as a source of financial risk,” Network for Greening the Financial System, April 2019. (pages 4-9).

The specific Learning Objectives for this online reading are as follows:

- Describe the six Network for Greening the Financial System (NGFS) recommendations for central banks, supervisors, policymakers, and financial institutions to manage environmental and climate-related risks.
- Explain how the NGFS recommendations can guide the financial sector in achieving the objectives of the Paris Agreement.

“The GHG Protocol: A corporate reporting and accounting standard (revised edition),” The Greenhouse Gas Protocol and World Business Council for Sustainable Development (WBCSD), March 2004. (Chapters 1, 3, 4).

The specific Learning Objectives for this online reading are as follows:

- Describe greenhouse gas (GHG) accounting and reporting principles.
- Explain the concept and importance of operational boundaries in GHG accounting.

All required online readings can be accessed at <https://www.garp.org/scr/readings/required>.

CHAPTER 5: GREEN AND SUSTAINABLE FINANCE: MARKETS AND INSTRUMENTS

EXAM WEIGHT | 8-12 questions

Learning Objectives

This chapter focuses on financial market developments relating to sustainability issues and climate-related risks and opportunities. The chapter begins by explaining what constitutes sustainable finance and its major categories and topical focus areas. It covers trends and flows in sustainable, green, and climate finance.

The chapter includes a detailed examination of specific sustainable and green finance instruments and products — such as green bonds, green loans, social bonds, sustainability-linked bonds and loans, and others — that compose sustainable funds. It then considers approaches investors use to integrate ESG and climate considerations into investment decisions and portfolio analysis. The chapter finishes with existing and emerging taxonomies and regulatory definitions, building on the policy material covered in Chapter 4.

The specific Learning Objectives for this chapter are as follows:

- Understand the key subcategories, focus areas, and overlaps of sustainable finance.
- Identify trends and flows in sustainable, green, and climate finance.
- Describe green, social, and sustainability bonds.
- Explain the core components of the Green Bond Principles.
- Describe green and social loans and their markets.
- Describe sustainability-linked bonds and loans.
- Describe sustainable and green funds, their investment strategies, environmental objectives, and roles in financial markets.
- Identify and explain consumer-facing, sustainable finance products.
- Understand key approaches and the integration of ESG and climate considerations into financial decision-making.
- Understand how investors impact sustainability strategy of a company.
- Describe the existing and emerging approaches to defining sustainable and green finance.
- Explain the trends in ESG disclosure requirements for companies.
- Identify regulatory trends in sustainable and green finance.

CHAPTER 6:

CLIMATE RISK MEASUREMENT AND MANAGEMENT

EXAM WEIGHT | 8-12 questions

Learning Objectives

This chapter describes how climate risk is measured and managed, covering both types of climate risk: physical and transition (as described in Chapter 3). The chapter covers in detail how climate risk relates to more traditional risk categories at the company level, including operational risk, credit risk, liquidity risk, and underwriting risk. It then discusses the potential of climate risk to cause systemic and financial stability risks.

The chapter goes on to describe available data and analytical tools for measuring physical and transition risks, building on material from Chapter 3. Finally, the chapter examines how climate risk can be, and is being, integrated into existing enterprise risk management (ERM) frameworks, ranging from governance structures and strategy setting to risk evaluation and disclosure. The material in this chapter sets the stage for Chapter 7, which builds on these topics by looking specifically at the application of scenario analysis to climate risk management.

The specific Learning Objectives for this chapter are as follows:

- Explain how climate risk manifests as financial risk through microeconomic and macroeconomic impacts.
- Describe how climate risk drivers cause company-level risk including operational, credit, liquidity, and underwriting risk.
- Describe how climate risk can be a source of systemic risk and potentially pose a risk to financial stability.
- Understand the associated risk metrics for and components of each risk type.
- Examine the effects of climate risk on micro (company-level) risks such as operational, credit, liquidity, and insurance.
- Understand transmission channels of climate risk, and how related systemic risk potentially threatens financial stability.
- Describe Climate Value at Risk and its uses.
- Describe the data types, analytical tools, and their sources to measure company-level transition and physical risks.
- Understand how to measure transition and physical risks at the portfolio level.
- Examine how climate risk drivers can be incorporated into existing enterprise risk management frameworks.

Required Online Reading:

“Implementing the Recommendations of the Task Force on Climate-related Financial Disclosures,” Task Force on Climate-related Financial Disclosures, October 2021. (pages 52-54).

The specific Learning Objectives for this online reading are as follows:

- Understand the key advantages and disadvantages of common carbon footprint and exposure metrics.
- Calculate the weighted average carbon intensity of investments, total carbon emissions, and carbon footprint, given a set of inputs.

This required online reading can be accessed at <https://www.garp.org/scr/readings/required>.

CHAPTER 7:

CLIMATE MODELS AND

SCENARIO ANALYSIS

EXAM WEIGHT | 8-12 questions

Learning Objectives

This chapter introduces scenario analysis as a strategic planning tool, then surveys widely-used reference scenarios developed by climate scientists, policy bodies, and industry groups. The chapter explores how scenario analysis can be used to assess climate-related risks, helping companies and financial institutions plan for a range of potential future outcomes. These outcomes use both physical and transition risk pathways, with links to international frameworks and regulatory guidance.

Additionally, the chapter explains how climate scenarios are used to model and quantify both acute and chronic physical risks and transition risks. It concludes with practical applications of scenario analysis in corporate strategy and financial risk management, highlighting use cases, limitations, and the evolving expectations from investors, regulators, and stakeholders.

The specific Learning Objectives for this chapter are as follows:

- Explain the components of climate scenario analysis and its application within organizations.
- Explain the purpose of global net-zero scenarios including carbon removal processes.
- Understand IPCC scenarios, including representative concentration pathways and shared socioeconomic pathways.
- Describe IEA scenarios and other key global reference scenarios.
- Understand the key choices that organizations need to consider for scenario development and analysis.
- Explain how scenarios, methodologies, and tools are used in scenario analysis to assess transition risk.
- Explain how climate models and scenario analysis are used to assess physical risk.
- Examine how all types of corporations (financial and non-financial) use climate scenario analysis.
- Differentiate transition and physical risk scenario planning.
- Describe the different use cases of scenario analysis for non-financial and financial organizations.

CHAPTER 8:

NET ZERO

EXAM WEIGHT | 3-6 questions

Learning Objectives

This chapter provides an overview of the concept of net zero and its implications for different players in the economy. It begins with the scientific rationale behind net-zero targets, linking them to global climate goals under the Paris Agreement. The chapter then surveys major international initiatives that are mobilizing governments, companies, and financial institutions to make climate commitments and take measurable steps toward decarbonization.

Additionally, the chapter outlines the various elements required to ensure the credibility of these targets. It explains the crucial role that transition plans can play in demonstrating that an organization is integrating decarbonization ambitions into its core strategy, emphasizing the importance of interim targets and pathways and the transparent use of metrics to measure progress. The chapter ends with a discussion of the emerging landscape of net-zero disclosure standards.

The specific Learning Objectives for this chapter are as follows:

- Explain the concept of net zero and how it relates to global climate goals.
- Describe the key actors in, and attributes of, net-zero target campaigns, and the challenges of the net-zero transition.
- Explain the key attributes of national and subnational net-zero target strategies and emission reduction approaches.
- Describe the factors that affect different sectors' abilities to achieve net zero.
- Describe the tools private sector actors can use to strengthen the credibility of net-zero commitments.
- Describe how net-zero pathways and interim targets are key to achieving credible and attainable net-zero targets across sectors.
- Understand the metrics and portfolio-alignment tools that can be used to track net-zero progress.
- Describe the net-zero disclosure landscape and key stakeholders.

CHAPTER 9:

CLIMATE AND NATURE

RISK ASSESSMENT

EXAM WEIGHT | 3-6 questions
Related to Case Study

Learning Objectives

This chapter examines the latest methodologies, frameworks, and organizations driving climate risk assessment, as well as nature risks. The chapter begins with a contextualization of climate risk assessments at the international, national, and regional levels, with a particular emphasis on new International Financial Reporting Standards (IFRS) S1 and S2 guidance from the International Sustainability Standards Board (ISSB). It also reviews climate risk tools and differentiates physical and transition risk assessment steps.

The chapter then introduces nature risk assessment and distinguishes it from climate risk. Various tools and methodologies, including the Taskforce on Nature-related Financial Disclosures (TNFD), are explored. The chapter concludes with a discussion on water risk assessments, policy, and financing.

The specific Learning Objectives for this chapter are as follows:

- Differentiate between climate risk measurement and assessment, and how these processes are crucial to effective climate risk management.
- Know the significant components of international and regional protocols for climate risk assessments.
- Understand ISSB reporting requirements and recommendations for scenario analysis and how these standards build on TCFD recommendations.
- Know the steps needed to conduct a physical and transition climate risk assessment.
- Define nature risk (including biodiversity and ecosystem subcomponents) and differentiate from climate risk.
- Understand the drivers of nature and water risks.
- Know the key components and steps of the TNFD and LEAP framework.
- Understand the challenges of and resources available to measure nature risk.
- Know the steps needed to conduct a water risk assessment for an organization.

CHAPTER 10:

TRANSITION PLANNING AND CARBON REPORTING

EXAM WEIGHT | 3-6 questions
Related to Case Study

Learning Objectives

Chapter 10 builds on Chapter 8 by delving deeper into key transition planning principles and steps. The chapter walks candidates through the latest Transition Plan Taskforce recommendations and implementation strategies. It also offers an overview of a variety of international transition standards, and contextualizes complementary standards established by the Glasgow Financial Alliance for Net Zero (GFANZ) and the Science-Based Targets initiative (SBTi).

Drawing from concepts introduced in Chapters 1, 4, and 6, the chapter takes a more granular approach to GHG accounting and reporting from both an organizational and a financial perspective. Key to creating a transition plan, the chapter covers concepts from the GHG Protocol Corporate Standard and Partnership for Carbon Accounting Financials (PCAF).

The specific Learning Objectives for this chapter are as follows:

- Describe transition plans and the different use cases for transition plans.
- Describe the three key principles for good transition planning, including the strategic and rounded approach.
- Know the principles for setting SBTi Net-Zero targets.
- Understand the five core elements of a good practice transition plan.
- Understand the equity share and control GHG emission consolidation approaches.
- Calculate emissions given a set of activity data, conversion factors, and global warming potentials.
- Describe financed emissions and the purpose of emission metrics to measure climate risk.
- Calculate a financial institution's attribution factor and financed emissions.
- Describe the PCAF Data Quality Score guidance, understanding hierarchies of data quality.
- Know the drivers of transition plan adoption beyond disclosures.

SCR CLIMATE PAL

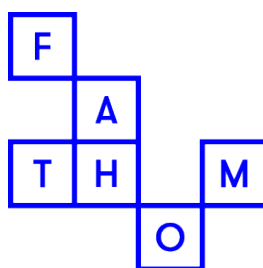
Case-Based Practical Applied Learning (Not Tested on Exam)

Learning Opportunities

To enhance the practical learning experience, GARP encourages candidates to use the SCR Climate PAL. This optional module incorporates methodologies and tools from actual climate data and risk management companies to walk candidates through concepts introduced throughout the curriculum. This experience encourages candidates to consider how an organization can tackle climate risks and provides SCR candidates with practical opportunities to do so.

The specific Learning Opportunities are as follows:

- **Climate Challenge:** Weigh the different choices an organization can make when facing today's various climate dilemmas.
- **GHG Reporting:** Calculate GHG emissions for a single facility and see how to aggregate emissions for entity-level reporting and target setting with **PersefoniPro**.
- **Physical Risk Prioritization:** Assess physical risk using probabilistic analysis with **riskthinking.ai**. Examine exposure, impact, and Value at Risk to prioritize resilience efforts.
- **Examine Risk Cross Dependencies:** View offsite risks that materially impact operations. Understand how to contextualize downscaled climate hazards using a structural analysis approach with **XDI**.
- **Flooding and Catastrophe Risk Modeling:** Explore how risk metrics can help organizations prepare for increasingly devastating flooding and catastrophic events across the globe. Transform hazard data into actionable risk quantification with **Fathom**.
- **Double Materiality Assessment:** Understand how to identify and report impact and financial materiality for EU Corporate Sustainability Reporting (CSRD) compliance and sustainability strategy with **Inclus**.
- **Scenario Analysis:** Use **Climate Interactive's** simplified integrated assessment model, En-ROADS, co-developed with MIT Sloan, to explore transition, physical, and systemic risks across different scenarios.



SCR EXAM ACRONYMS

A list of acronyms and terms used on the SCR Exam. This list, or a similar list, will be provided to all exam candidates on the day of the Exam.

BECCS = bioenergy with carbon capture and sequestration	IPCC = Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change
CCUS = carbon capture, utilization, and storage	ISSB = International Sustainability Standards Board
CEO = chief executive officer	KPI = key performance indicator
CO₂ = carbon dioxide	mm = million
CO₂e = carbon dioxide equivalent	mt = metric ton
COO = chief operating officer	NDC = nationally determined contribution
COP = Conference of the Parties	NGFS = Network for Greening the Financial System
COSO = Committee of Sponsoring Organizations of the Treadway Commission	NGO = non-governmental organization
CRO = chief risk officer	OECD = Organization for Economic Co-operation and Development
CSO = chief sustainability officer	PRB = Principles for Responsible Banking
CSRD = Corporate Sustainability Reporting Directive	PRI = Principles for Responsible Investment
CSR = corporate social responsibility	RCP = Representative Concentration Pathway
CVaR = Climate Value at Risk	SASB = Sustainability Accounting Standards Board
ERM = enterprise risk management	SBTi = Science-Based Targets initiative
ESG = environmental, social, and governance	SDG = Sustainable Development Goal
ETS = emission trading system	SLB = sustainability-linked bond
EU Taxonomy = EU Sustainable Finance Taxonomy	SLL = sustainability-linked loan
EV = electric vehicle	SSP = shared Socioeconomic Pathway
GBP = Green Bond Principles	SPT = sustainability performance targets
GHG = greenhouse gas	TCFD = Task Force on Climate-related Financial Disclosures
GRI = Global Reporting Initiative	TNFD = Taskforce on Nature-related Financial Disclosures
IAM = integrated assessment model	UN = United Nations
ICMA = International Capital Market Association	UNEP FI = United Nations Environment Programme Finance Initiative
IEA = International Energy Agency	

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Founded in 1996 and governed by a Board of Trustees, GARP is headquartered in Jersey City, N.J., with offices in London and Hong Kong. For more information, visit garp.org.

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